

Drumadon

Essentials



Resources for drummers of all levels
by Isaac Long

First Edition - 2026

Foreword

I wrote this manual to serve as a practical guideline for drummers seeking a more well-rounded technique and flow around the kit, with emphasis on improvising. Although the book is loosely chronological, it explores a wide variety of styles and techniques that I consider essential. Every player's path is different, so readers are encouraged to study the pages most relevant to their own goals. This is not a theory book; rather, it is intended to be studied alongside theory in order to support a deeper and more complete musical understanding.

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Contact Drumadon
5 Arthur Road
Lesmurdie, WA, 6076

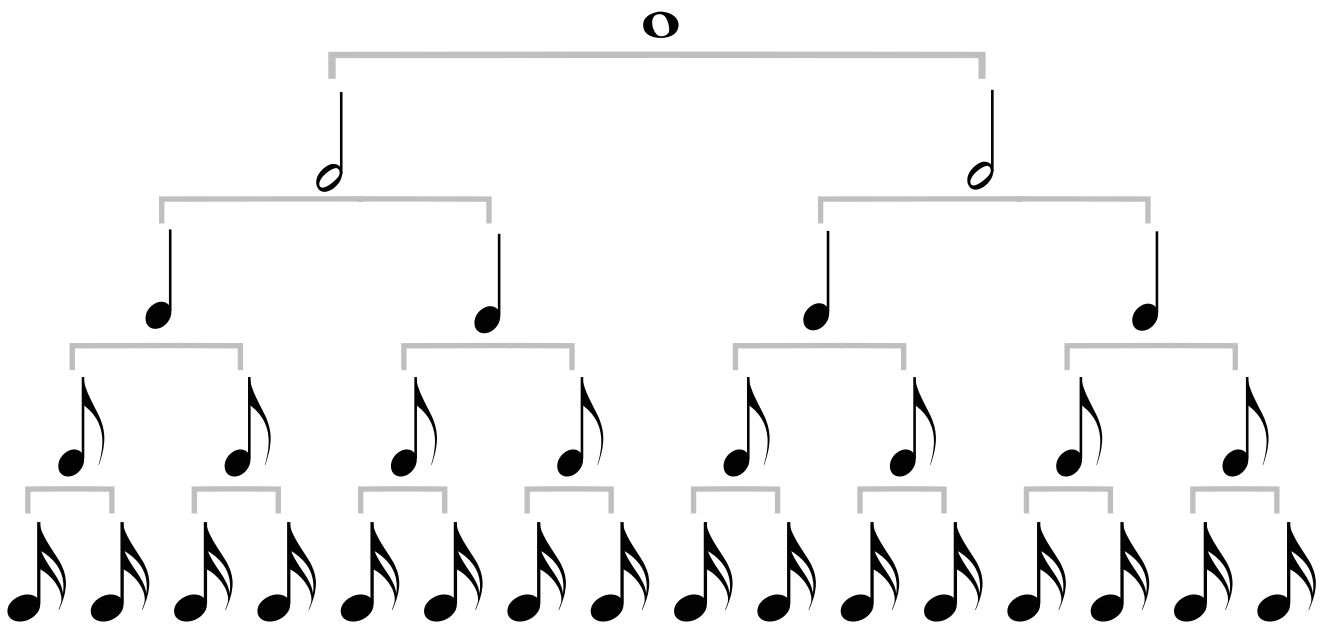
www.drumadon.com.au
info@drumadon.com.au
Ph: 0487 854 934

Syllabus Designer:
Isaac Long

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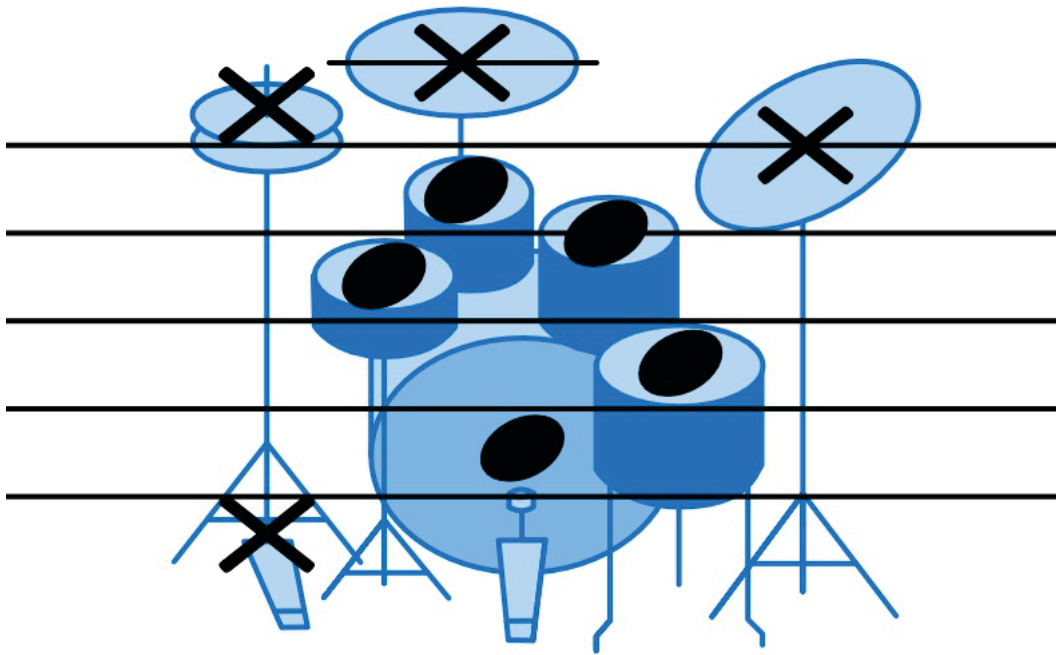
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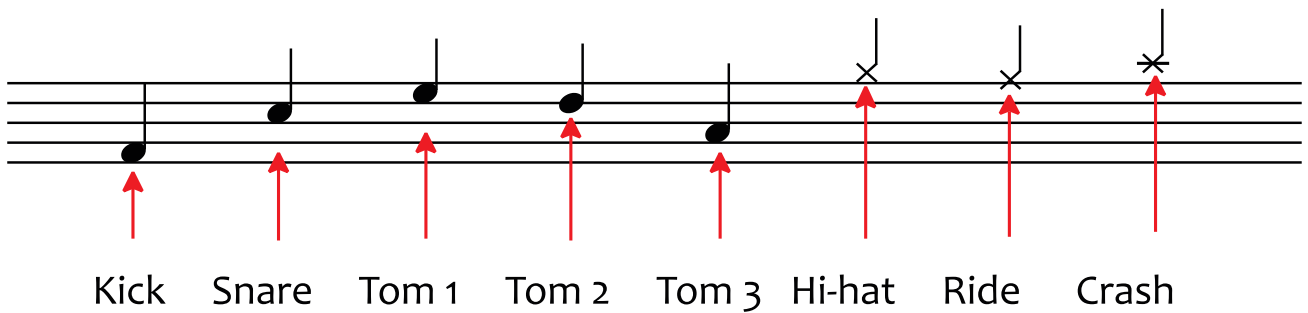


Name	Notes	Rest	Beats
Whole			4
Half			2
Quarter			1
Eighth			$\frac{1}{2}$
Sixteenth			$\frac{1}{4}$

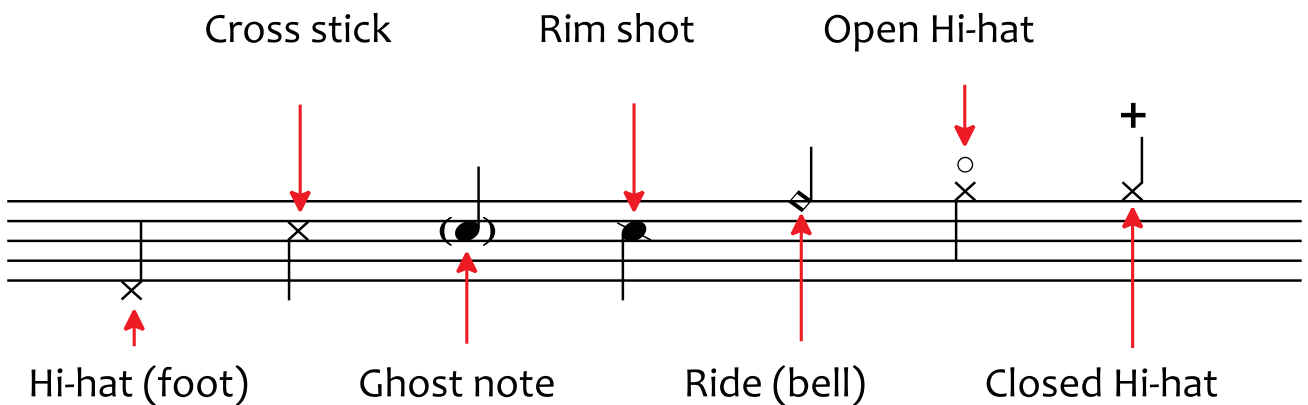
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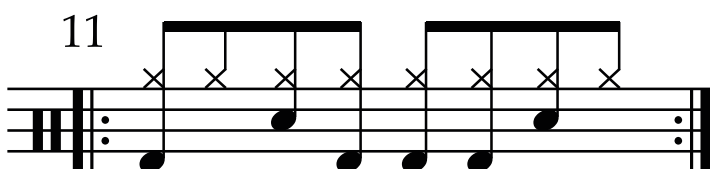
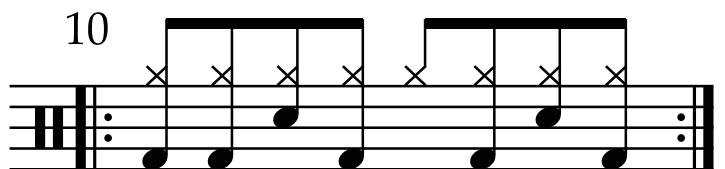
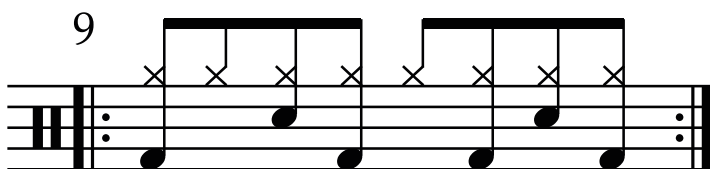
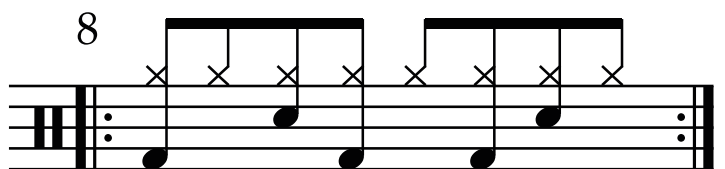
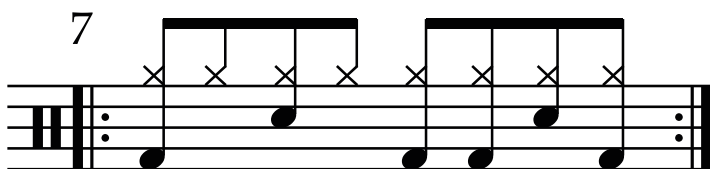
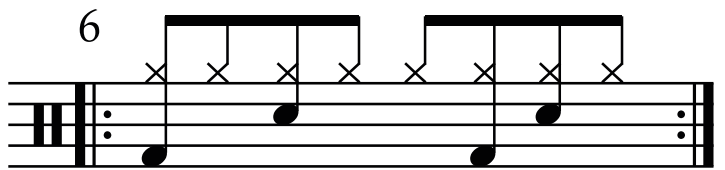
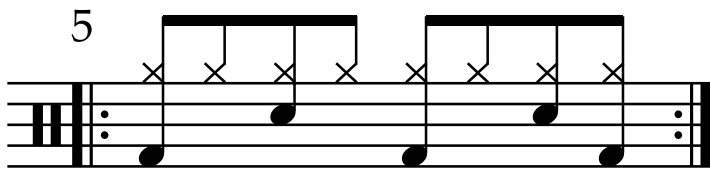
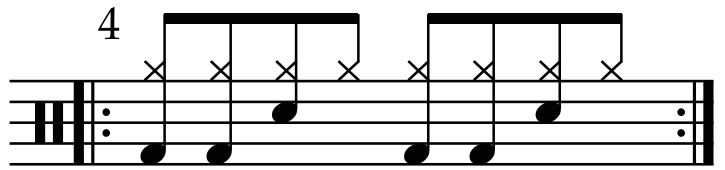
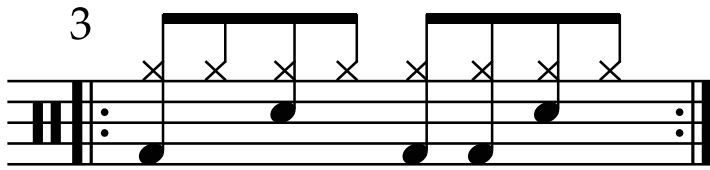
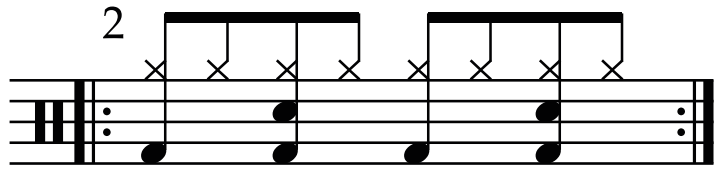
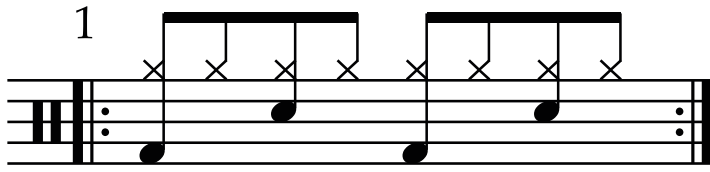
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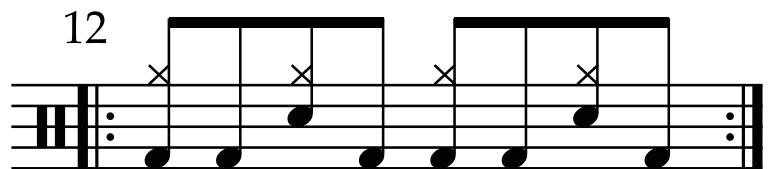
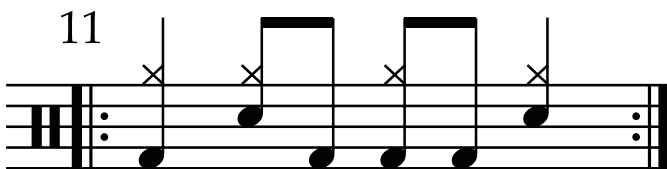
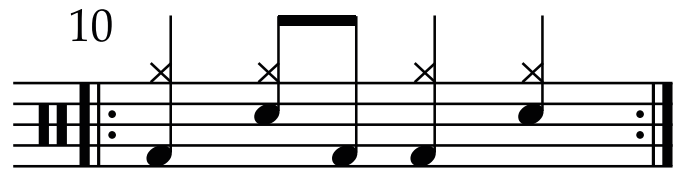
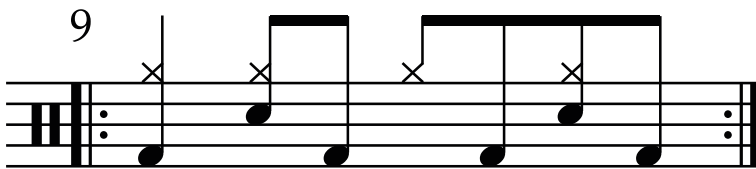
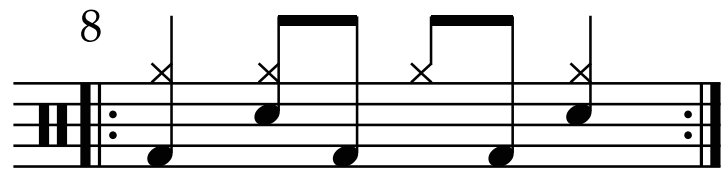
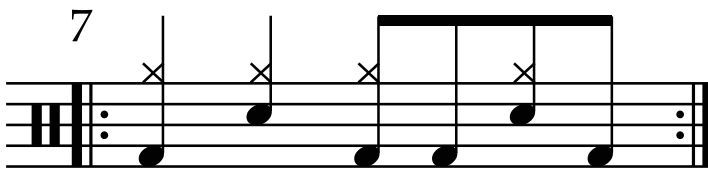
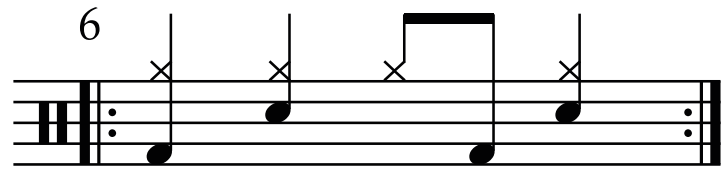
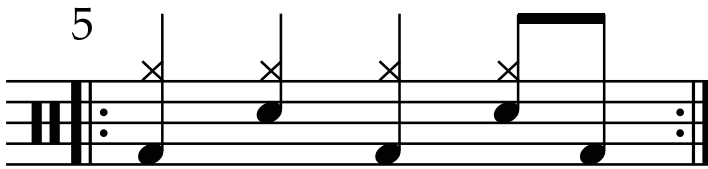
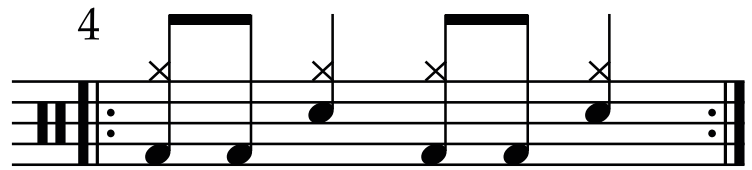
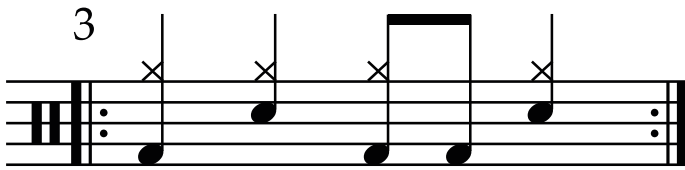
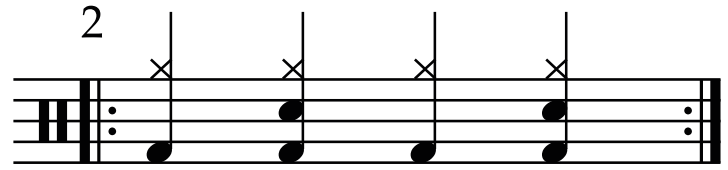
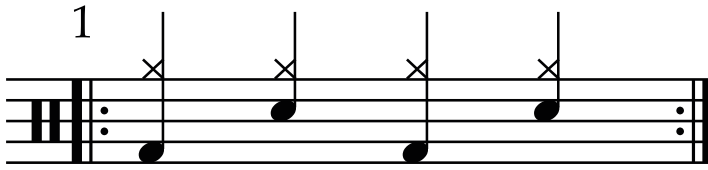
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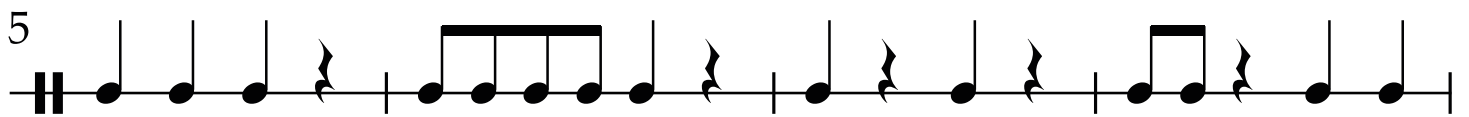
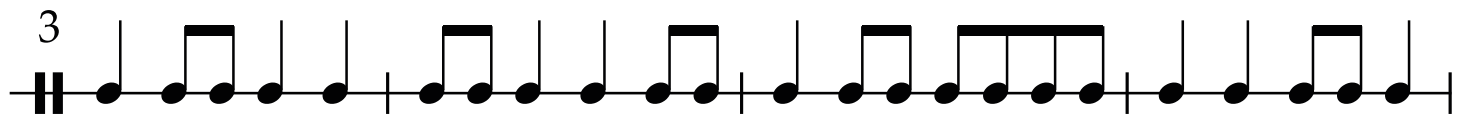
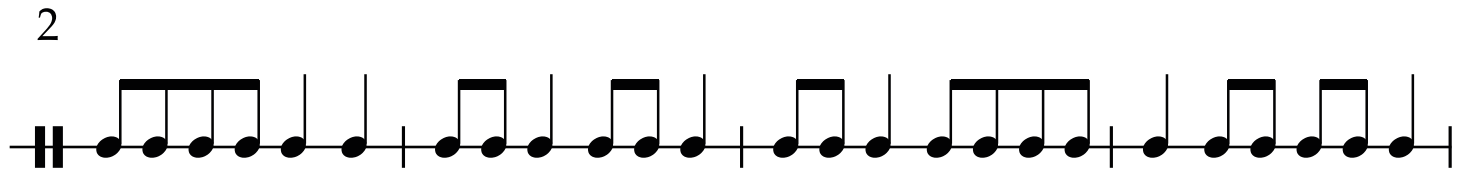
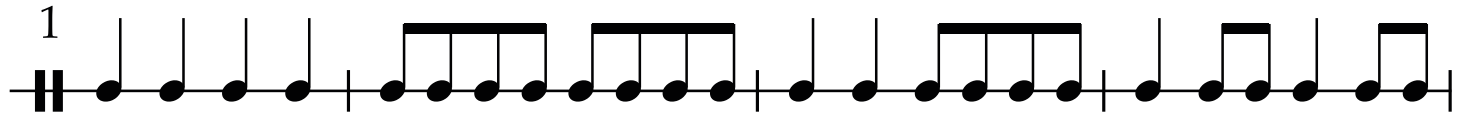
Eighth Note Beats



Quarter Note Beats



Rhythm Reading #1



Rudiments

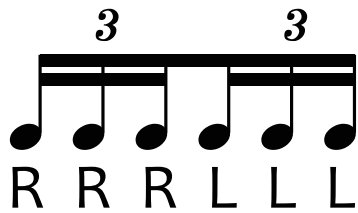
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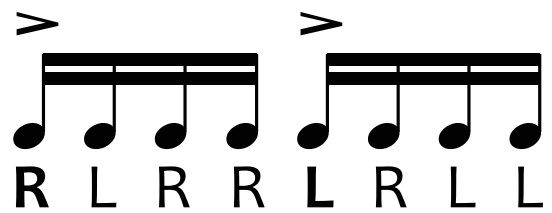
Double Stroke Roll



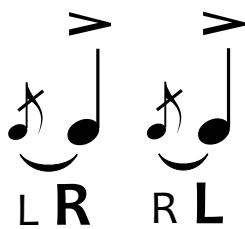
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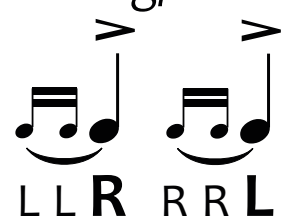
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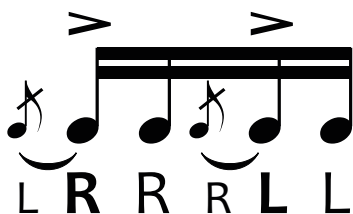
Flam



Drag/Ruff



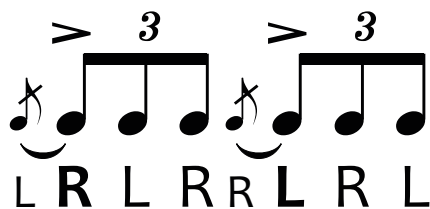
Flam Tap



Drag Tap



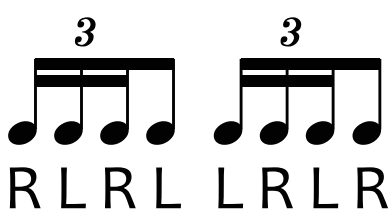
Flam Accent/Flam Triplet



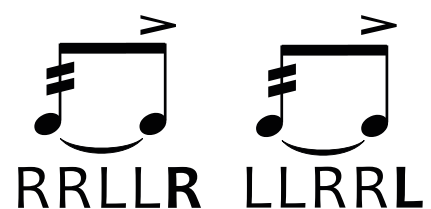
Buzz Roll



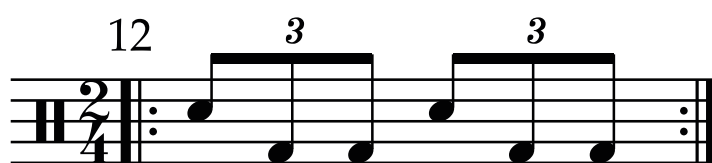
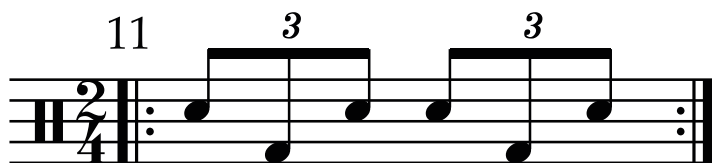
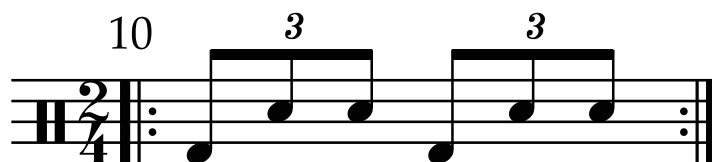
Single Stroke Four



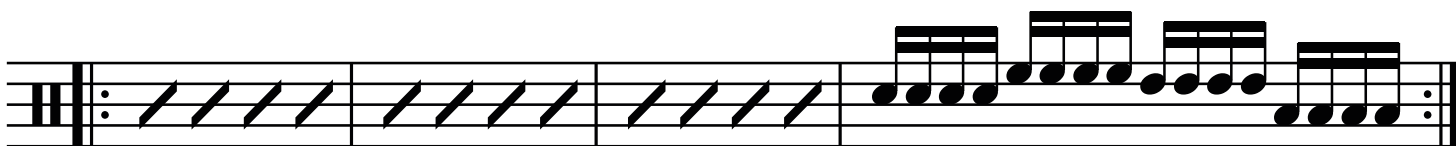
Five Stroke Roll



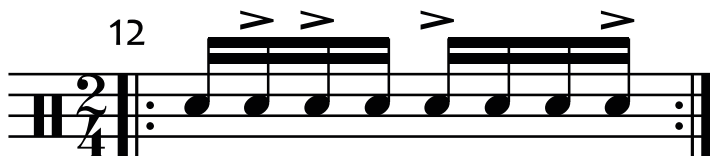
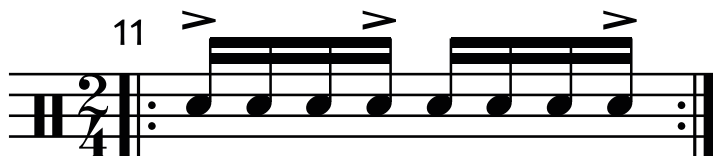
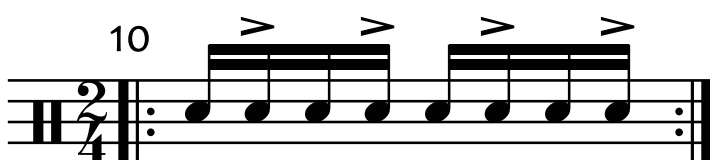
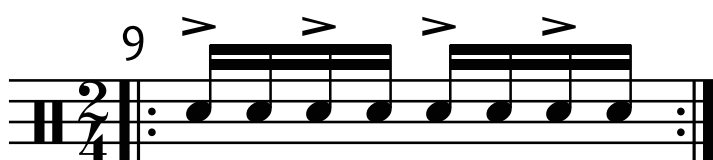
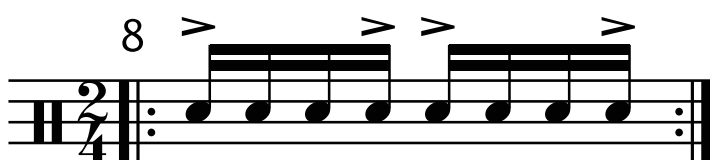
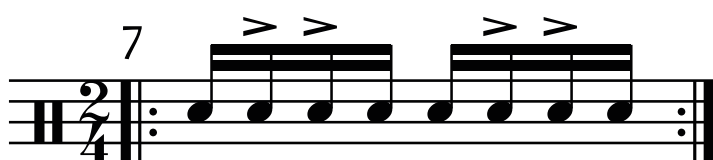
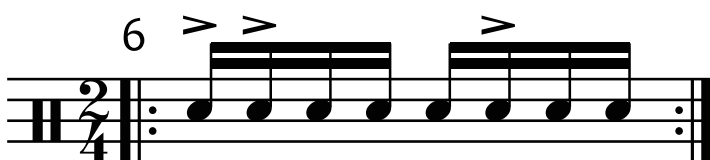
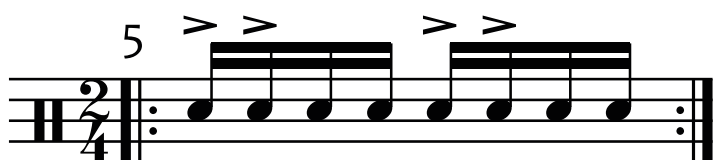
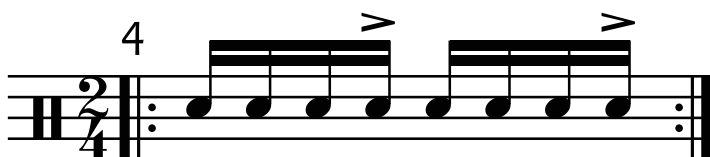
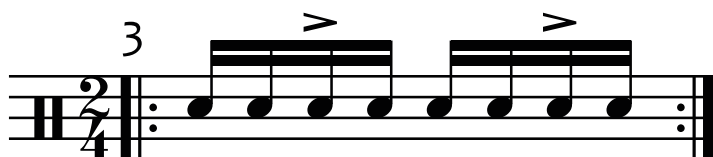
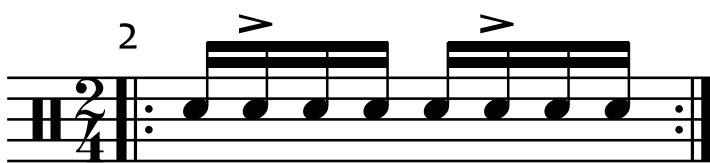
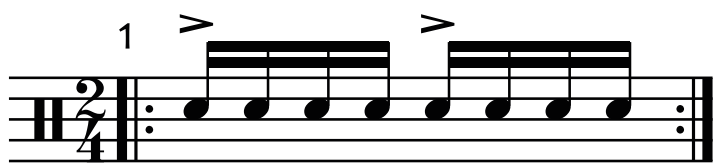
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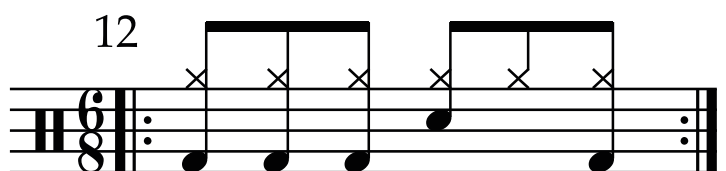
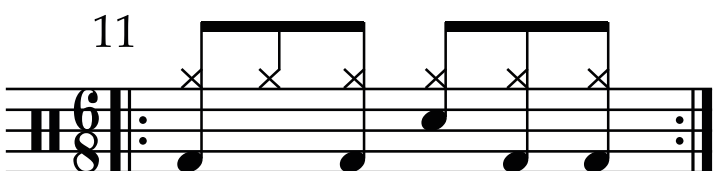
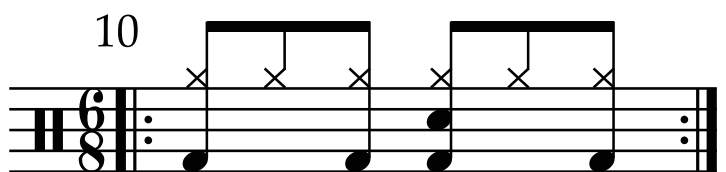
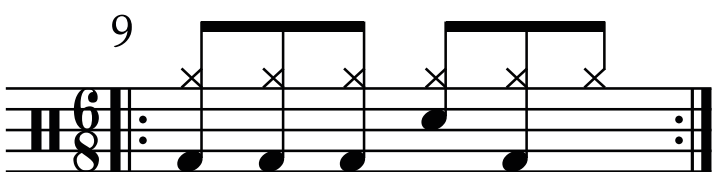
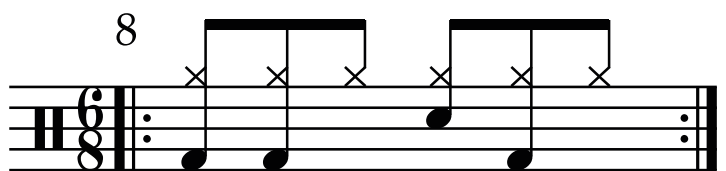
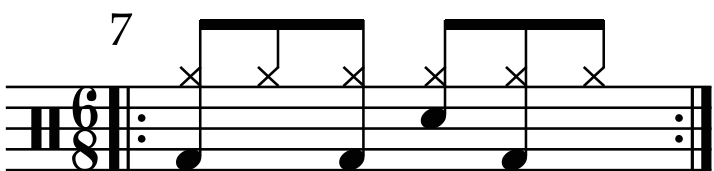
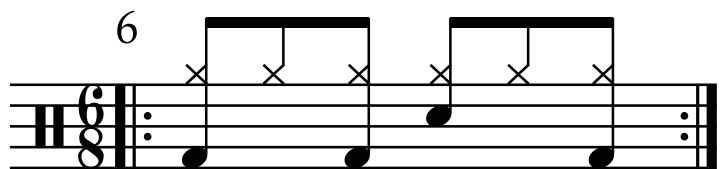
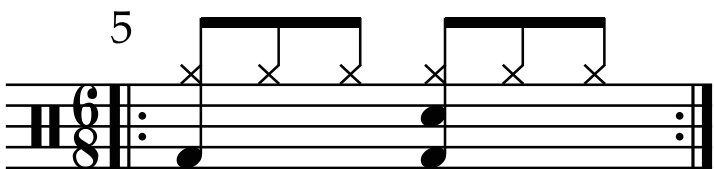
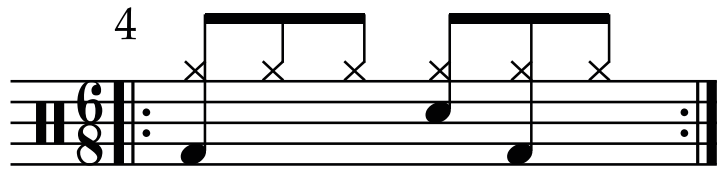
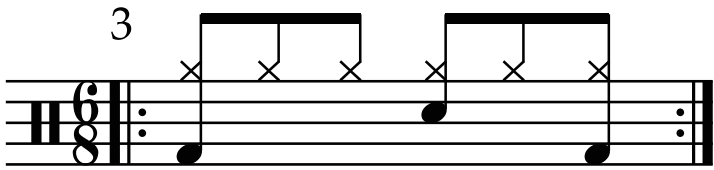
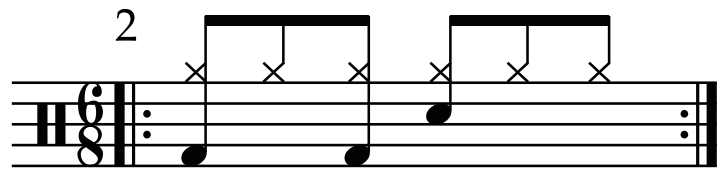
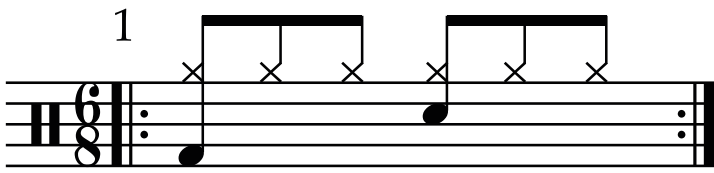
Drum Fills



Accent Study



6/8 Beats



Paradiddle Study #1

1 > >
RLRRRL**R**LL

2 >> >>
RLRRRL**R**LL

3 > >>
RLRRRL**R**LL

4 >> >
RLRRRL**R**LL

5 > >
RLRRRL**R**LL

6 > >
RLRRRL**R**LL

7 >> >
RLRRRL**R**LL

8 > >>
RLRRRL**R**LL

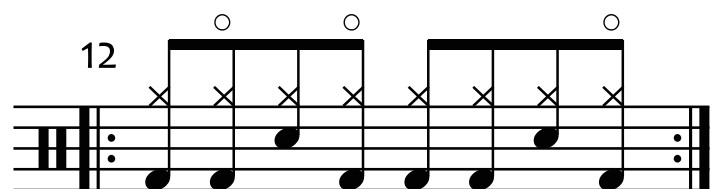
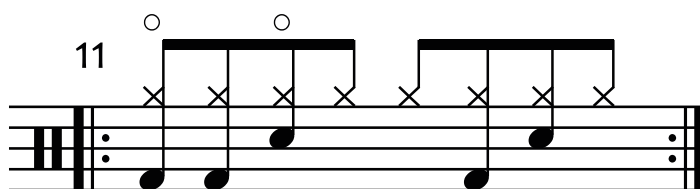
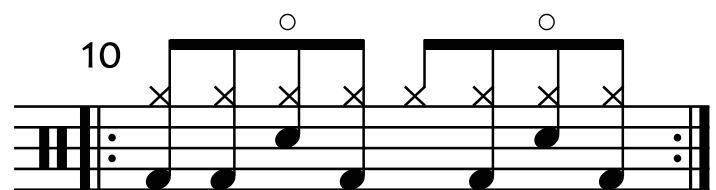
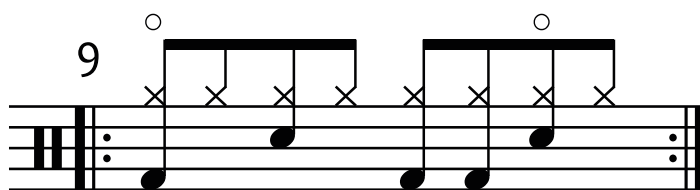
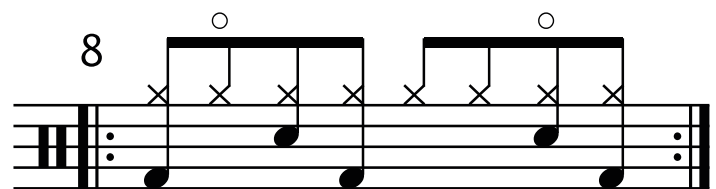
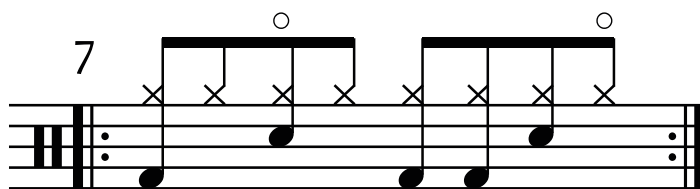
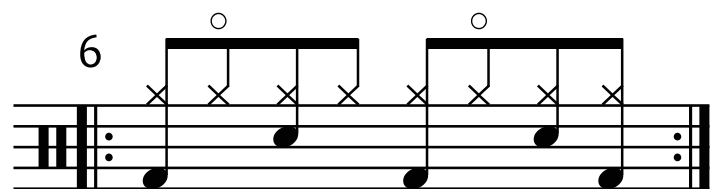
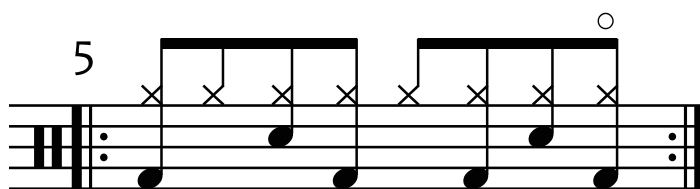
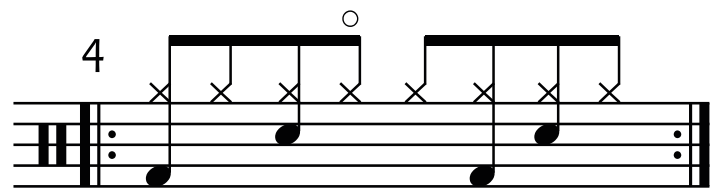
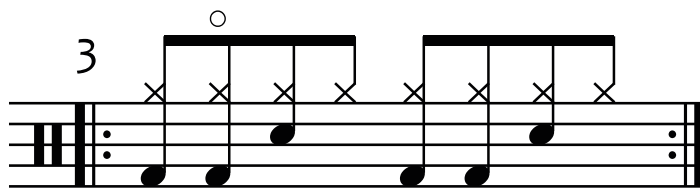
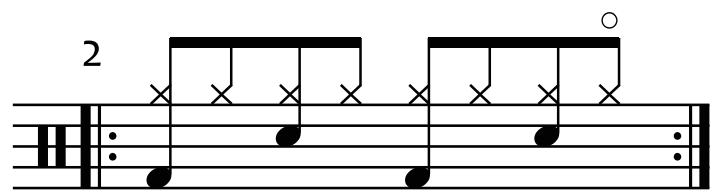
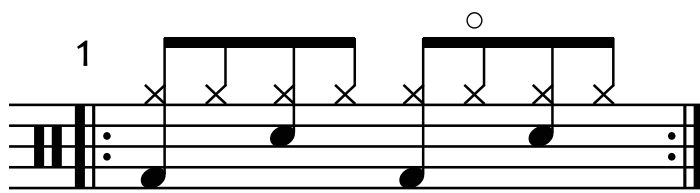
9 >
RLRRRL**R**LL

10 >
RLRRRL**R**LL

11 >>
RLRRRL**R**LL

12 > >
RLRRRL**R**LL

Open Hi-hats



Shuffle Grooves

The second system of the musical score for 'The Little Boat' consists of two staves. The upper staff continues the melody from the first system, starting with a quarter note G4, followed by eighth notes A4 and B4, and then a quarter note C5. Above the staff, there are four groups of three eighth notes, each marked with a '3' and a bracket, indicating triplets. The lower staff continues the accompaniment, starting with a quarter note G3, followed by eighth notes A3 and B3, and then a quarter note C4. The system concludes with a double bar line and repeat dots.

The first system of the musical score for 'The Little Boat' consists of two staves. The upper staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). It contains a sequence of five eighth notes, each beamed together with a quarter note, forming five eighth-note triplets. The notes are G4, A4, Bb4, A4, and G4. The lower staff is a bass clef with a key signature of one flat. It contains a sequence of five eighth notes, each beamed together with a quarter note, forming five eighth-note triplets. The notes are E3, F3, G3, F3, and E3. The system is marked with a repeat sign at the beginning and end.

Exercise 6: A musical staff with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The notation shows a sequence of sixteenth notes. Above the staff, there are four groups of three sixteenth notes, each marked with a '3' and a bracket, indicating triplets. The first group starts on the second line (D4), the second on the second space (E4), the third on the third line (F#4), and the fourth on the third space (G4). The notes are: D4, E4, F#4, E4, D4, F#4, G4, E4, D4, G4, A4, B4, A4, G4, F#4, E4, D4. The piece ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.

[illegible]

10

3 3 3 3

The musical notation for Exercise 10 consists of a single staff with a treble clef. It begins with a repeat sign (two dots). The first measure contains a quarter rest followed by a triplet of eighth notes (G4, A4, B4). The second measure contains a triplet of eighth notes (B4, C5, D5). The third measure contains a quarter rest followed by a triplet of eighth notes (D5, E5, F5). The fourth measure contains a triplet of eighth notes (F5, G5, A5). The piece ends with a repeat sign. Above the staff, the number '10' is written, and above each triplet, the number '3' is written.

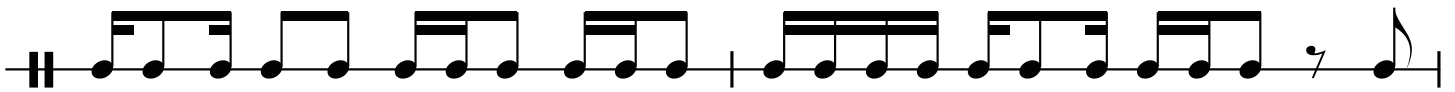
11

3 3 3 3

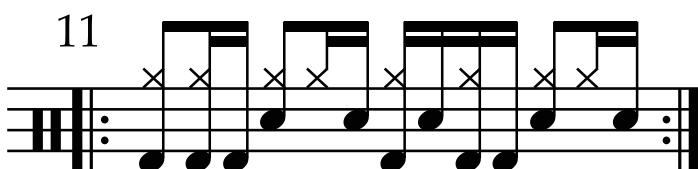
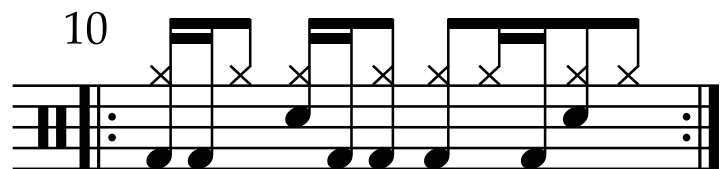
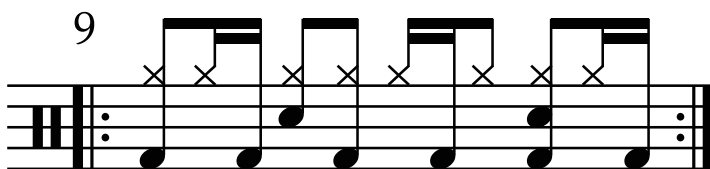
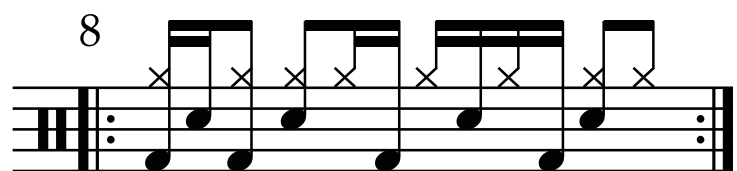
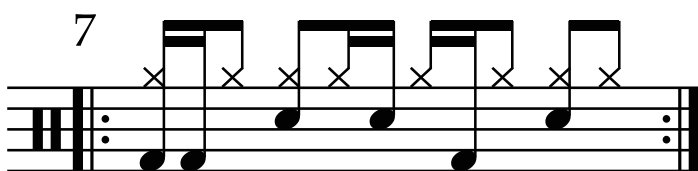
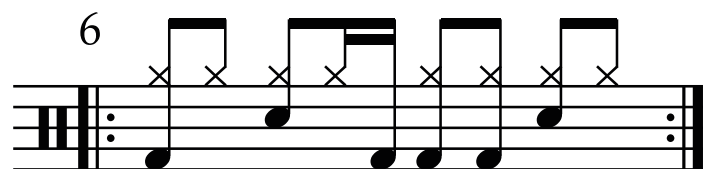
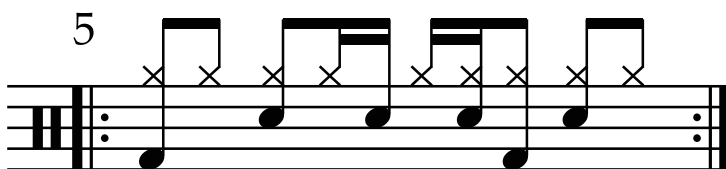
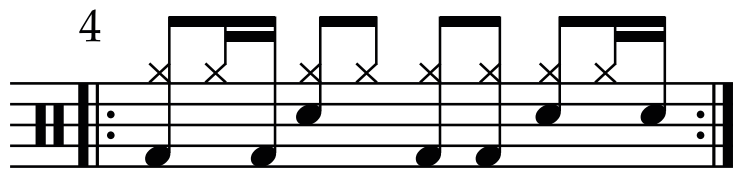
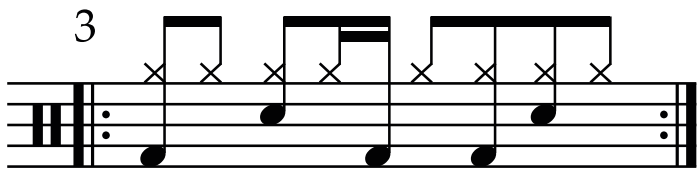
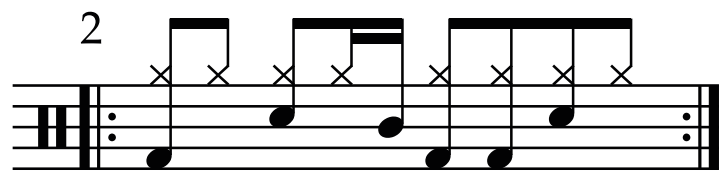
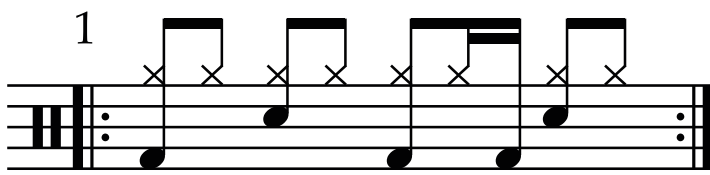
The musical notation for exercise 11 consists of a single staff with a treble clef. It begins with a repeat sign (two dots). The first measure contains a dotted quarter note (half note with a dot) and an eighth note (half note with a flag). The second measure contains a dotted quarter note and an eighth note. The third measure contains a dotted quarter note and an eighth note. The fourth measure contains a dotted quarter note and an eighth note. The fifth measure contains a dotted quarter note and an eighth note. The sixth measure contains a dotted quarter note and an eighth note. The seventh measure contains a dotted quarter note and an eighth note. The eighth measure contains a dotted quarter note and an eighth note. The piece ends with a repeat sign. Above the staff, there are four triplet markings (three dots) over the eighth notes in measures 2, 3, 4, and 5.

The first system of the musical score is for the piano. It consists of two staves. The upper staff is in treble clef and contains a sequence of four eighth notes, each beamed together with a sixteenth note. Above each pair of notes is a bracket with the number '3' above it, indicating a triplet. The lower staff is in bass clef and contains a sequence of four eighth notes, each beamed together with a sixteenth note. Above each pair of notes is a bracket with the number '3' above it, indicating a triplet. The system is marked with a double bar line and repeat signs at both ends.

Rhythm Reading #2



Sixteenth Note Beats



Paradiddle Study #2

R L R R L R L L

Single 

Inward 

Reverse 

Outward 

Paradiddle

> >
R L R R L R L L

Outward Paradiddle

> >
R L R L L R L R

Reverse Paradiddle

> >
R R L R L L R L

Inward Paradiddle

> >
R L L R L R R L

Paradiddle

> >
R L R R L R L L

Outward Paradiddle

> >
R L R L L R L R

Reverse Paradiddle

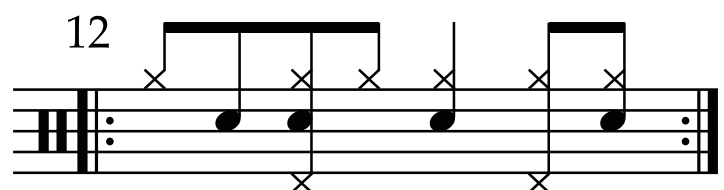
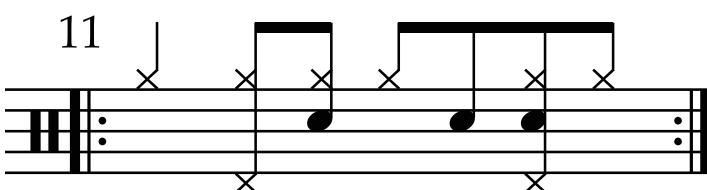
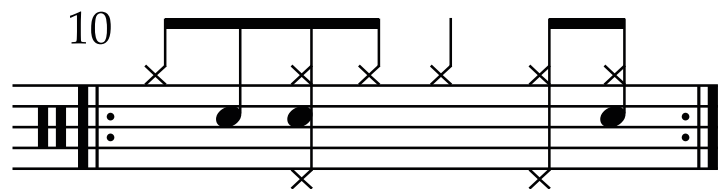
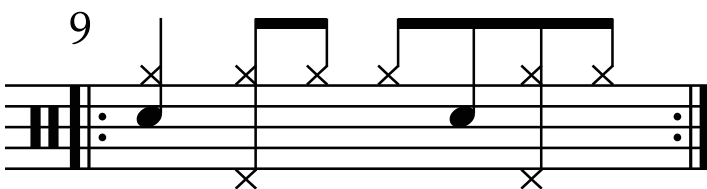
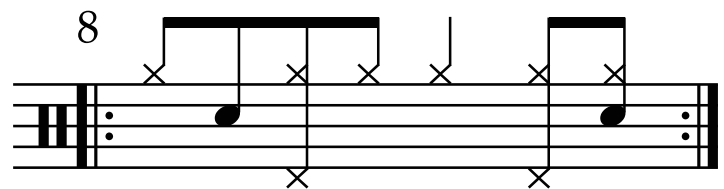
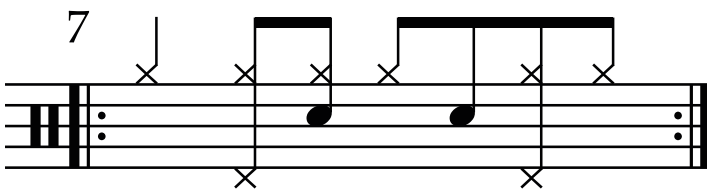
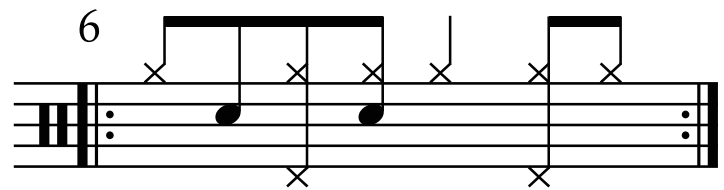
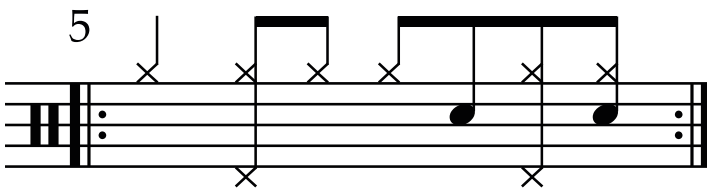
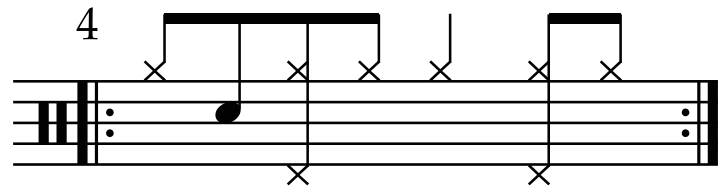
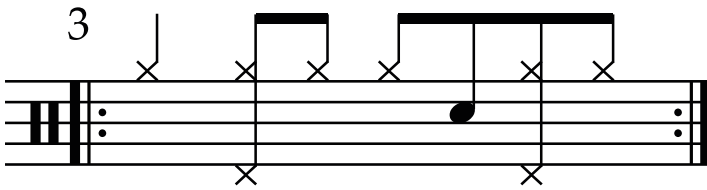
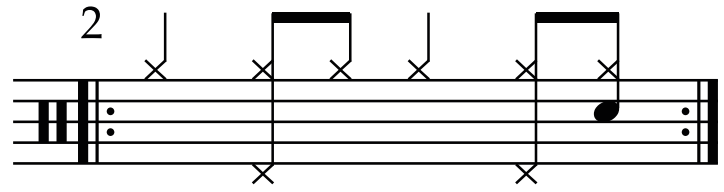
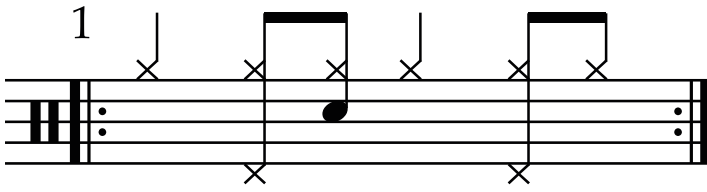
> >
R R L R L L R L

Inward Paradiddle

> >
R L L R L R R L

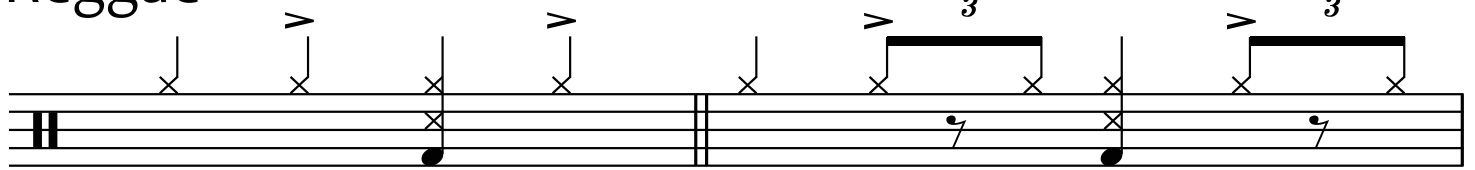
Jazz Comping

$$\text{♪} = \text{♪}^3 \text{♪}$$

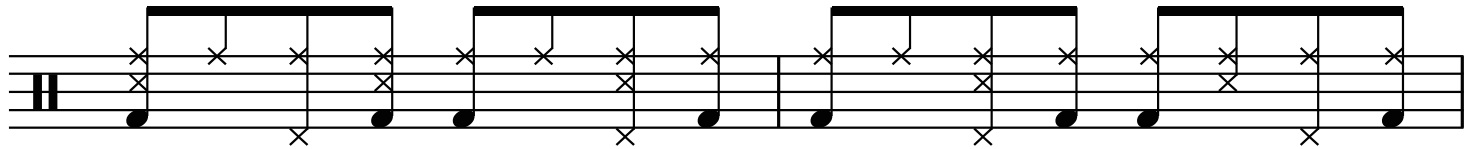


World Grooves

Reggae



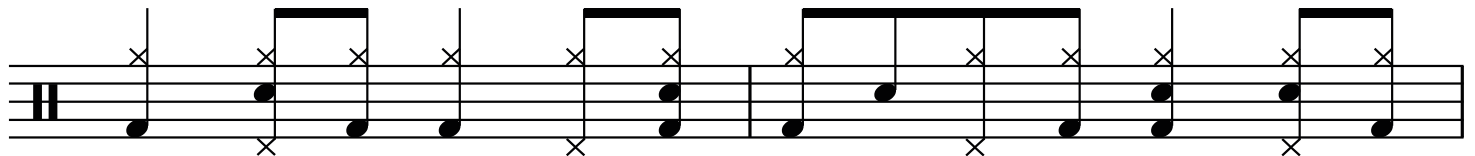
Bossa Nova



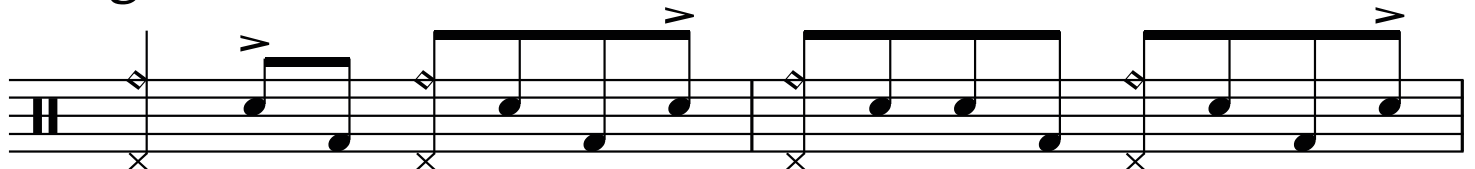
Cha-Cha



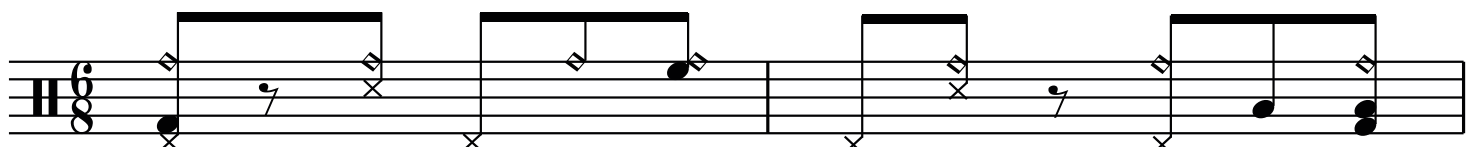
Samba



Songo



Bembe



Odd Time Signatures

